



Guard Your Steps - 09.27.26

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Ecclesiastes 5:1-7(NIV)

Guard your steps when you go to the house of God. Go near to listen rather than to offer the sacrifice of fools, who do not know that they do wrong.

2 Do not be quick with your mouth,
do not be hasty in your heart
to utter anything before God.

God is in heaven
and you are on earth,
so let your words be few.

3 A dream comes when there are many cares,
and many words mark the speech of a fool.

4 When you make a vow to God, do not delay to fulfill it. He has no pleasure in fools; fulfill your vow. 5 It is better not to make a vow than to make one and not fulfill it.

6 Do not let your mouth lead you into sin. And do not protest to the temple messenger, "My vow was a mistake." Why should God be angry at what you say and destroy the work of your hands? 7 Much dreaming and many words are meaningless. Therefore fear God.

1. Watch your step as you come to the house of God to worship

Ecclesiastes 5:1(NIV)

Guard your steps when you go to the house of God. Go near to listen rather than to offer the sacrifice of fools, who do not know that they do wrong

Reflect on who he is...

God is infinite — we are finite.

God is immortal — we are mortal.

God is almighty — we are weak.

God is holy — we are sinful.

God is omniscient — we are ignorant.

God is unchangeable — we are fickle.

God is faithful — we are unfaithful.

2. Worship is more about listening than talking

Ecclesiastes 5:2(NIV)

Do not be quick with your mouth,
do not be hasty in your heart
to utter anything before God.

God is in heaven
and you are on earth,
so let your words be few.

3. The vows we make to God matter

Ecclesiastes 5:4-7(NIV)

When you make a vow to God, do not delay to fulfill it. He has no pleasure in fools; fulfill your vow. 5 It is better not to make a vow than to make one and not fulfill it.

6 Do not let your mouth lead you into sin. And do not protest to the temple messenger, “My vow was a mistake.” Why should God be angry at what you say and destroy the work of your hands? 7 Much dreaming and many words are meaningless. Therefore fear God.

“Louie was on the raft. There was gentle Phil crumpled up before him, Mac’s breathing skeleton, endless ocean stretching away in every direction, the sun lying over them, the cunning bodies of the sharks, waiting, circling. He was a body on a raft, dying of thirst. He felt words whisper from his swollen lips. It was a promise thrown at heaven, a promise he had not kept, a promise he had allowed himself to forget until just this instant: If you will save me, I will serve you forever. And then, standing under a circus tent on a clear night in downtown Los Angeles, Louie felt rain falling. It was the last flashback he would ever have. Louie let go of Cynthia and turned toward Graham. He felt supremely alive. He began walking. “This is it,” said Graham. “God has spoken to you. You come on.”

— Laura Hillenbrand, **Unbroken: A World War II Story of Survival, Resilience, and Redemption**

4. Worship is more about giving than receiving

A - We give worship God with our wallet

Nehemiah 10:39

The people of Israel, including the Levites, are to bring their contributions of grain, new wine and olive oil to the storerooms, where the articles for the sanctuary and for the ministering priests, the gatekeepers and the musicians are also kept.

“We will not neglect the house of our God.”

B - We give worship to God by showing up to the house of God

Psalm 27:4(NIV)

One thing I ask from the Lord,
this only do I seek:
that I may dwell in the house of the Lord
all the days of my life,
to gaze on the beauty of the Lord
and to seek him in his temple.

Psalm 84:10(NIV)

Better is one day in your courts
than a thousand elsewhere;
I would rather be a doorkeeper in the house of my God
than dwell in the tents of the wicked.

C - We give worship God by serving the house and the people of God

Psalm 84:10-12 -The Message

I'd rather scrub floors in the house of my God than be honored as a guest in the palace of sin.

D - We give worship God with the fruit of our lips giving praise

Psalm 95:1-2(NIV)

Come, let us sing for joy to the Lord;
let us shout aloud to the Rock of our salvation.
2 Let us come before him with thanksgiving
and extol him with music and song.

E - We give worship to God by offering an totally surrender heart

Matthew 15:8-9(NIV)

These people honor me with their lips,
but their hearts are far from me.
9 They worship me in vain;
their teachings are merely human rules.

John 4:23–24 (NIV)

Yet a time is coming and has now come when the true worshipers will worship the Father in the Spirit and in truth, for they are the kind of worshipers the Father seeks. God is spirit, and his worshipers must worship in the *Spirit and in truth.*

F - We give worship to God by approaching him with awe and reverence

Hebrews 12:28–29 (NIV)

Therefore, since we are receiving a kingdom that cannot be shaken, let us be thankful, and so worship God acceptably with reverence and awe, for our 'God is a consuming fire.'"

5. Fear God

Ecclesiastes 5:7(NIV)

Much dreaming and many words are meaningless. Therefore fear God.

Ecclesiastes 12:13

Now all has been heard;

here is the conclusion of the matter:

Fear God and keep his commandments,
for this is the duty of all mankind.

Biblical fear isn't simply terror.

It's reverence, awe, humility, and recognizing God's rightful place.

Guard your steps → Fear God.

Listen carefully → Fear God.

Watch your words → Fear God.

Keep your promises → Fear God.

Are we Guarding our steps?

Are we listening?

Are we watching our words?

Are we keeping our promises to God?

Are we Giving God his rightful place?